

Chapter 19

Receiving Yan Si's affirmative answer, Yin Lingzhu turned her toes around and headed toward her original bedroom.

Yin Lingzhu didn't understand Yan Si's intentions—why was she insisting on making her stay?

But this didn't prevent her from staying one night here in order to get the divorce certificate.

She comforted herself—sleeping was sleeping, no matter where.

With this thought, Yin Lingzhu's psychological pressure decreased significantly.

When she pushed open the bedroom door, it was pitch black inside, with only a sliver of light coming in. Yin Lingzhu's breathing became uneven.

Too dark.

Yin Lingzhu stepped back a little. Even though the light switch was right by the door, she didn't dare reach out to touch it.

Her gaze moved from the bedroom to Yan Si. Yan Si was standing in the living room, watching her the whole time.

Would it be inappropriate to ask Yan Si to help turn on the lights?

She forced herself to overcome her fear, pressed her hand against the switch as quickly as possible, then pulled it back.

The small switching sound echoed in the bedroom. Before Yin Lingzhu could feel relieved, she discovered a serious problem.

The switch had been pressed, but the light didn't turn on.

At this moment, Yan Si spoke up, "The bedroom light seems to be broken."

"Why didn't you find someone to fix it?" Yin Lingzhu's tone was heavy due to her fear.

Yan Si looked at her, "I didn't know the light was broken."

Yin Lingzhu stared at the Yan Si in front of her and moved farther away from that dark doorway.

"Do you have a desk lamp?" Yin Lingzhu asked.

When she used to live here, because she was afraid of the dark, she had kept a desk lamp on her nightstand and had also prepared a small flashlight that could last a long time.

But she had thrown everything away.

She had taken nothing with her except her identification documents.

Yan Si thought of the desk lamp on her own nightstand and shook her head, "No."

Hearing Yan Si's answer, Yin Lingzhu helplessly looked at her phone's flashlight.

Her phone battery wasn't much either—she couldn't possibly keep the flashlight on all night connected to a charging cable.

Finally, Yin Lingzhu made up her mind, "I'll sleep in the living room tonight."

Yan Si hadn't expected Yin Lingzhu to say this and was stunned for a moment, "You can sleep in my bedroom."

This time it was Yin Lingzhu who was caught off guard. It took her a while to collect her thoughts.

"Thank you, but sleeping in the living room is fine." Yin Lingzhu said.

"Sleeping in the living room, you'll catch cold." Hearing Yin Lingzhu's refusal, Yan Si said anxiously.

"It doesn't matter if I catch cold. Aren't you the one who insisted I stay?" Yin Lingzhu spoke in a flat tone, appearing indifferent.

Hearing this, Yan Si's eyes dimmed for a moment, then seemed to remember something and became even brighter.

"Then go wash up first. There are disposable toiletries in the bathroom, and I'll tidy up the living room." Yan Si said gently to Yin Lingzhu, her eyes curved with a tender smile.

Yin Lingzhu noticed Yan Si's smile and was stunned again for a moment.

This was the first time she had seen Yan Si smile at her. Although Yan Si had come looking for her many times during this period, Yan Si had always had a cold expression each time.

Yin Lingzhu stared at Yan Si for a while before realizing her behavior. She hurriedly ran toward the bathroom with an air of fleeing in panic.

Seeing Yin Lingzhu like this, Yan Si's smile grew even wider.

Yin Lingzhu locked the bathroom door behind her. She cupped some water in her palms and splashed it on her face.

She was really going crazy. Just now, seeing Yan Si smile, she actually had an impulse to disregard everything and want to be with Yan Si.

Yin Lingzhu lowered her eyes. Water droplets hung on her thick eyelashes, concealing the emotions in her gaze.

She looked at the disposable toothbrushes, towels, and other items that had been set out, and couldn't help but sigh. It seemed Yan Si had been determined to make her stay.

While Yin Lingzhu was busy in the bathroom, Yan Si was staring at the sofa with difficulty outside.

After hesitating for a long time, she made up her mind, picked up the water glass on the table, and did something she would never have done before.

Yin Lingzhu was using the hair dryer to dry her half-wet hair when a sound louder than the hair dryer assaulted her eardrums.

She put down the hair dryer and hurried to check.

Opening the door, she saw obvious water stains on the sofa and glass fragments glinting with light.

Glass fragments?

"Why are there glass fragments on the sofa?" Yin Lingzhu couldn't help but wonder.

Yan Si's voice carried a grievance, "I was just trying to drink some water, but I spilled it, and the glass broke too."

Yan Si stood next to the sofa looking completely at a loss, like a child who had done something wrong.

Yin Lingzhu still didn't understand, "Why would glass fragments end up on the sofa?"

The sofa was fifty to sixty centimeters off the ground—it couldn't possibly splash up there. Even if some pieces flew up, there should only be a little bit.

Yin Lingzhu also noticed that there were almost no fragments on the floor—most of them were on the sofa.

It couldn't possibly have broken on the sofa, could it?

"There was a dumbbell¹ on the sofa." Yan Si seemed to see what Yin Lingzhu was thinking and explained.

Only then did Yin Lingzhu notice that there really was a dumbbell on the sofa.

Its color was very similar to the sofa's color—you couldn't notice it without looking carefully.

Why would someone have such a uniquely colored dumbbell, and place it on the sofa?

But now wasn't the time to worry about these things.

"So where will I sleep tonight?" Yin Lingzhu looked in Yan Si's direction.

Yan Si still looked like a child who had made a mistake, not daring to lift her head, "You can sleep in my room."

Hearing her answer, Yin Lingzhu raised an eyebrow and asked back, "Then where will you sleep? Sleep with me?"

But what Yin Lingzhu didn't expect was that Yan Si actually nodded.

Yin Lingzhu really couldn't understand Yan Si now. It seemed she had never understood her before either.

"Whatever." She dropped this line and went to dry her hair that still wasn't completely dry.

Yan Si understood Yin Lingzhu's meaning—she had agreed.

Yan Si quickly went to the bedroom and hurriedly hid the desk lamp under the bed.

When Yin Lingzhu entered Yan Si's bedroom, Yan Si had just finished laying out a set of bedding.

"You rest first, I'll go wash up." Seeing Yin Lingzhu at the door, Yan Si immediately got up and said to her.

Yan Si brushed past Yin Lingzhu, bringing with her a wave of fragrance.

It was the scent of roses.

The scent of Yan Si's pheromones.

Yin Lingzhu shook her head, trying to dispel that scent from her nasal cavity.

Her glands were already damaged now—how could she possibly smell other people's pheromones?

She had just seen in the bathroom that Yan Si used rose-scented body wash. It was probably that scent.

There were now two sets of bedding on the bed. Yin Lingzhu chose the one that had just been brought out.

She stood by the bed, mentally dividing the bed in half.

In the bathroom, Yan Si looked at herself in the mirror. Her face was flushed with excitement, looking very animated.

Water vapor still lingered in the air. Yan Si knew this was left from when Yin Lingzhu had showered earlier.

Yan Si sniffed the air, but smelled nothing.

In the bedroom, Yin Lingzhu tossed and turned, unable to fall asleep. She could only sit up in bed in frustration, half-sitting.

Her gaze swept across Yan Si's bedroom.

Before, when she came here, she hadn't dared to look around casually because she was afraid it would make Yan Si unhappy.

Now she didn't have this concern, and her eyes scanned over the various items.

Yan Si's bedroom was different from what she had imagined. She had thought that someone like Yan Si would have a minimalist style bedroom.

She looked at the small cat figurine on the nightstand. This kind of cute collectible was completely unexpected for something Yan Si would buy.

The carpet with white bear prints, and the anti-slip pads on the table legs in the shape of little dogs.

Yin Lingzhu tried to recall—when she had come to Yan Si's bedroom before, had these things been there?

The answer was: she didn't know.

At that time, Yin Lingzhu had been too cautious around Yan Si. Even when coming here, she hadn't dared to look around, and besides, Yan Si always turned off the lights, so Yin Lingzhu had even less opportunity to see.

Yin Lingzhu's gaze fell on the nightstand, where there was a piece of paper with handwriting she was very familiar with.

It was her writing.

【May your heart be like mine, never betraying our mutual love.²】

【I really like Yan Si】

This was something she had written before. During the days of waiting for Yan Si, she had carefully watched every TV drama and movie that Yan Si had acted in.

The first line came from a period drama where Yan Si played a young lady from a wealthy family, words she said to her beloved.

The second line was her own feelings.

At that time, Yin Lingzhu had copied down this line, fantasizing that Yan Si might like her even a little bit.

The white paper had already yellowed somewhat, and the edges had become fuzzy—clearly it had been handled many times.

Yin Lingzhu had originally wanted to take that note, but then stopped her outstretched hand.

Whatever reason Yan Si had for keeping the note, it had nothing to do with her anymore.

Yet Yin Lingzhu's gaze didn't move away from the note. Her feelings for Yan Si weren't entirely due to love at first sight.

Yin Lingzhu recalled her previous world, but before she could sink into memories, she was interrupted.

Yan Si came in.

Yin Lingzhu glanced at Yan Si and said nothing, burrowing into her own blanket.

Seeing Yin Lingzhu's behavior, Yan Si also didn't speak. She walked to the other side, lifted the unoccupied blanket, and lay down.

Yin Lingzhu had her back to that side. Although she couldn't see, she could hear the sound of Yan Si's clothes rubbing against the sheets and could smell Yan Si's scent.

Still the rose fragrance.

Did Yan Si like roses that much?

Yin Lingzhu wanted to bury her head under the blanket so she wouldn't be disturbed by Yan Si, but that would be too strange.

Yin Lingzhu didn't feel sleepy at all, so she started counting sheep in her mind.

During the counting process, she kept feeling that the rose scent from Yan Si was getting closer to her.

When Yin Lingzhu had counted to twenty sheep, the rose scent at her nose tip was too strong to ignore.

She was currently lying on her side, so she changed positions to lie flat on her back.

She discovered that Yan Si's face was only ten centimeters from her own face—they were almost touching.

Yan Si had practically squeezed into her blanket.

No wonder she could smell such a strong rose scent.

Yin Lingzhu suddenly sat up. Her movement woke Yan Si.

Yan Si frowned and opened her eyes, looking at Yin Lingzhu with drowsy eyes that weren't quite awake.

"Why are you so close to me?" Yin Lingzhu asked in confusion.

A two-meter by two-meter bed with two people sleeping should only take up half the space.

"I might have unconsciously moved closer to you after falling asleep." Yan Si explained while rubbing her eyes.

"Well, now that you're awake, go back to your original position." Yin Lingzhu said, while tucking her blanket tightly around herself.

"Oh, oh." Yan Si obediently nodded, her soft hair rubbing against her pillow.

Watching Yan Si retreat to the other side, Yin Lingzhu thought that Yan Si was quite obedient when she had just woken up.

Footnotes:

¹ **Dumbbell (啞鈴)**: Exercise equipment consisting of weights connected by a bar, used for strength training.

² **"May your heart be like mine, never betraying our mutual love" (只願君心似我心，定不負相思意)**: This is a famous line from a classical Chinese poem by Li Zhiyi from the Song Dynasty, expressing the hope that one's beloved will be as faithful and devoted as oneself.